



Mastering the Present Continuous

Actions happening now and plans for the future.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Identify actions happening at this moment.
- Schedule future arrangements confidently.
- Express temporary situations and changing trends.
- Practice oral fluency using the 'be + verb-ing' structure.





What's happening right now?

THE HOOK

Look around you. Is someone drinking coffee? Are people talking? In English, when we describe the **immediacy** of life, we use the Present Continuous.

Key point

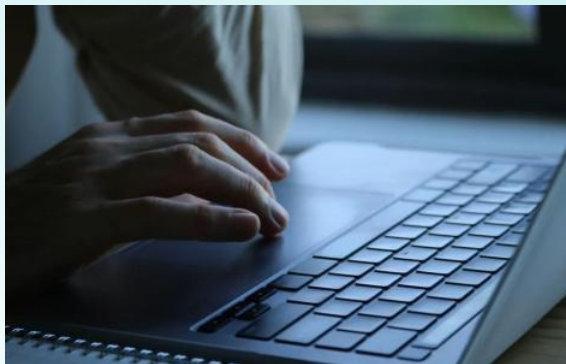
Structure: Subject + am/is/are + verb-ing

Immediate Actions

We use this tense for things in progress at this very moment.



On the phone - She is talking to her client right now.



Writing - I am writing an important email right now.



Studying - They are studying English this afternoon.

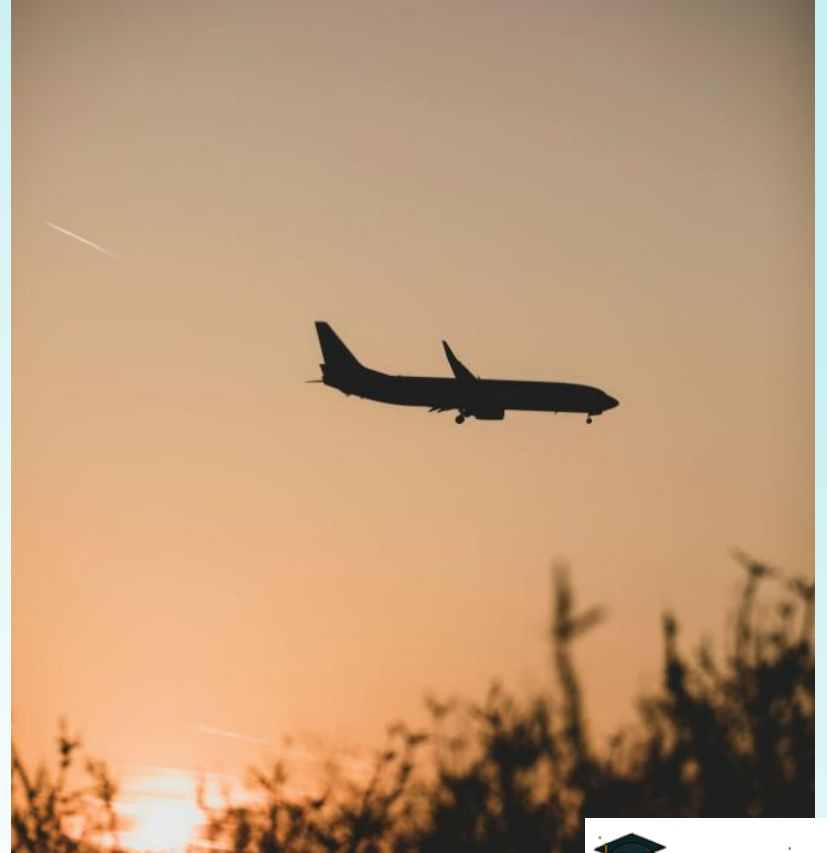
Beyond the 'Now': Future Plans

Surprise! We also use the Present Continuous for **future arrangements** that are already decided.

Example

- I am flying to London next week.
- We are meeting our friends tomorrow.

This shows the plan is scheduled. It feels more 'certain' than just a vague intention.



Now vs. Future

Right Now

Focus on the current second.

He is eating lunch right now.



Future Plans

Focus on a scheduled event.

He is having lunch with his boss tomorrow.



Special Uses



ADVANCED USAGE

1. **Temporary Situations:** 'I am living in Santiago for three months.' (It's not permanent).
2. **Changing Trends:** 'More people are using electric cars these days.'
3. **Irritation:** Use with 'always' to complain. 'He is always leaving his clothes on the floor!'

Busy Schedules

Listen to the audio and decide: true or false?



A Conversation about Plans

▶ Play audio

- 1 | Sarah is going to the gym tonight.
- 2 | Sarah is meeting her parents for lunch tomorrow.
- 3 | Sarah is flying to Valparaíso on Saturday.
- 4 | Mark is going to Valparaíso too.

Answers on the next slide...

Busy Schedules

Check your answers below



A Conversation about Plans

▶ Play audio

1



Sarah is working late tonight.

2



She explicitly says she is meeting them for lunch.

3



She mentions her trip to Valparaíso on Saturday morning.

4



Mark is staying home to clean his apartment.

Practice the Structure

Right now, I ____ (study) English, and tomorrow morning, we ____
(meet) for coffee. My brother ____ always ____ (lose) his keys!

Word bank 

is, am studying, was, lost, meets, are meeting, study, losing

Answers on the next slide...

Practice the Structure



Right now, I **am studying** (study) English, and tomorrow morning, we **are meeting** (meet) for coffee. My brother **is** always **losing** (lose) his keys!

Word bank 

is, am studying, was, lost, meets, are meeting, study, losing

Speaking Practice: Your Week



Tell your partner about your current life and upcoming plans. Use the Present Continuous for both!

Speaking Practice: Your Week



You might have said...

I am working on a new project at the office this week.

I am meeting my siblings for dinner this Friday night.

More and more people in my neighborhood are riding bikes to work.

I am taking a cooking class every Tuesday this month.